
EJIMAX-C

VOLUME 1

AI TEXT-TO- AUDIO NOVEL GENERATION HANDBOOK

A Complete, Standalone Training Manual & Operational Blueprint for Turning Public-Domain Novels into Captivating Audio Drama

*Companion volume: Volume 2 — Ejimax-C Audio-to-Image
and Movie Cinema Generation Handbook*

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DEDICATION

Dedicated to every storyteller who believes technology should amplify human creativity for the greater good of mankind rather than replace it.

PREFACE

Stories have always connected humanity. This handbook provides a structured, beginner-friendly production methodology for transforming novels into immersive audiobooks and preparing them for future AI-assisted cinematic adaptation.

INTRODUCTION

Volume 1 establishes the complete foundation of the EJIMAX-C production system, covering story selection, adaptation, narration, sound design, production workflow, publishing, and preparation for future movie generation.

Foundations • Sourcing & Story Development • Audio Production

Publishing Your Audio • Team & Operations Appendices: Resources • Templates • Case Studies • Glossary • Launch Plan

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PART I

Foundations

Vision, legal grounding, and the audio production pipeline

Chapter 1

Vision & Mission of This Handbook

Welcome to Volume 1 of the EJIMAX-C Handbook series. This book is a complete, standalone guide to one craft: turning free, legally clear novels into captivating audio drama — narrated, voiced, and sound-designed to modern listening standards. You do not need Volume 2 to use this book. Everything here takes you from an empty project folder to a finished, published audio episode. Adopt the producer mindset, and understand the long-term vision of building multimedia intellectual property.

1.1 Mission Statement

To make the world's free literature irresistible again — one voice, one scene, one listener at a time.

1.2 What This Volume Produces

- Serialized audio-drama adaptations of public-domain and Creative Commons novels.
- Full-cast narration performed entirely by AI voice tools, directed for emotional accuracy.
- Layered sound design — ambience, effects, and licensed music — that turns narration into immersive audio drama.
- Publish-ready audio episodes for podcast platforms, YouTube (audio-only), and social audio clips.

1.3 About This Two-Volume Series

This handbook is Volume 1 of 2 in the EJIMAX-C production series. Volume 1 (this book) covers everything from sourcing a book through publishing a finished audio episode. Volume 2 — Audio to Image and Movie Cinema Generation Handbook — picks up exactly where this book ends: taking a finished audio episode and turning it into AI-generated cinematic video. The two volumes share a consistent method and vocabulary, but each is fully self-contained. If your goal is an audio-only podcast or audio-drama channel, this volume alone is everything you need.

Companion volume: *If you later want to expand into short-form video content built on top of your audio episodes, Volume 2 continues the pipeline using the exact audio files this book teaches you to produce.*

1.4 Who This Handbook Is For

Reader	How to Use This Handbook
Solo creator starting an audio-drama channel	Follow it front-to-back as a step-by-step production course.
A future scriptwriter/adaptor	Start at Part II — Sourcing & Story Development.
A future voice/audio producer	Start at Part III — Audio Production.
A future social/podcast manager	Start at Part IV — Publishing Your Audio.
A new collaborator on day one	Start at Part V, Chapter 18 — Onboarding New Collaborators.

1.5 Core Production Values

1. Do not worry about mastering every AI application. First understand the production workflow. Once the workflow is clear, learning new tools becomes much easier.
2. Legally clean, always. Every title starts from a verified public-domain or Creative Commons source.
3. Ear-first, always. Every decision in this book is optimized for how something sounds, not how it reads on a page.
4. Direct, don't just generate. Treat every AI voice take as a performance to be directed, not a button to press once.
5. Build your identity around storytelling and production principles rather than any single software platform.
6. Template everything. If a task will happen more than once, it gets a checklist or template in this handbook.
7. Write a personal vision describing the type of audiobook and AI media studio you hope to build within the next one year+.
8. Build consistency through ethical creativity to achieve long-term intellectual property.
9. Publish, measure, iterate. A finished episode is the start of a feedback loop, not the end of the job.

How to use this book: Every chapter ends with a checklist. Treat the checklists as your actual production tracker — copy them into your project management tool of choice.

Chapter 2

How This Handbook Works

This is a reference manual, not a novel — you are not expected to read it in one sitting. It is organized so that anyone on the team can open the exact chapter they need for the task in front of them and find a complete, self-contained answer.

Framework: *Story → Adaptation → Narration → Sound Design → Publishing → Audience Feedback → Continuous Improvement.*

2.1 Structure at a Glance

Part	Covers
I. Foundations	Vision, legal basics, audio production pipeline
II. Sourcing & Story Development	Finding books, evaluating them, adapting prose into script
III. Audio Production	Voice design, AI narration tools, sound design, QA
IV. Publishing Your Audio	Export specs, growth tactics, content calendar, analytics
V. Team & Operations	Roles, onboarding, quality control, troubleshooting
Appendices	Resource compilation, full template library, worked case studies, glossary, launch plan

2.2 Icons & Conventions Used Throughout

Element	Meaning
Tip box (shaded, gold label)	A practical shortcut or common pitfall to avoid
Quoted box (left navy bar)	A guiding principle worth remembering
Numbered list	A sequential procedure — follow in order
Bulleted list	A non-sequential set of options or considerations
☐ Checklist item	Copy into your tracker; check off before moving to the next stage

Element	Meaning
Flow diagram (colored boxes)	The high-level shape of a workflow, left to right
Staged table diagram	A workflow with detailed descriptions per stage

2.3 Living Document Policy

This handbook should be updated every time you discover a better tool, a faster technique, or a mistake worth documenting. Treat Chapter 19 (Quality Control & Brand Standards) as the place new standards get formally adopted, and treat this handbook itself as version-controlled — date each major revision on the inside cover.

A successful audiobook is not simply read—it is directed. The listener should feel guided through the story rather than presented with information.

Chapter 3

Legal Foundations: Public Domain, Creative Commons & Copyright Safety

Every production decision in this handbook rests on one non-negotiable foundation: the source material must be legally free to adapt, narrate, and monetize. Understand copyright fundamentals, distinguish between copyrighted and public-domain works, identify when permission is required, and apply ethical AI practices throughout audiobook production. This chapter is the single source of truth for that clearance process.

3.1 The Three Legal Categories You Will Work With

Category	What It Means	Can You Monetize?
Public Domain	Copyright has expired or was never claimed; no owner exists.	Yes, freely, in most jurisdictions.
Creative Commons (CC BY / CC BY-SA)	Author retains copyright but pre-approves reuse with attribution.	Yes, with credit given as specified.
Creative Commons Non-Commercial (CC BY-NC)	Reuse allowed, but not for commercial/monetized projects.	No — do not use for monetized content.

Every novel, illustration, recording, and screenplay is protected by intellectual property law unless it has entered the public domain or is released under a suitable license. Respecting copyright protects creators and reduces legal risk. Public-domain works may generally be used without requesting permission, subject to local laws. Before adapting any novel, verify its copyright status using reliable official or reputable sources.

Never assume that content found online is free to use. Always verify ownership, licensing terms, and any restrictions before beginning production. Not every work in copyright is unavailable for adaptation. Authors and publishers may grant licenses that define how their work can be used. Before beginning production, identify the copyright owner, request permission where required, and keep written records of all agreements.

AI should be used to assist creativity, not to misrepresent authorship or infringe on the rights of others. Always disclose AI assistance where appropriate, verify generated content, and ensure your productions respect creators, audiences, and applicable laws.

3.2 The Clearance Checklist

Run every single title through this checklist before it enters production. No exceptions.

- ☐ Confirm original publication date and country of first publication.
- ☐ Confirm the specific edition/translation you're using is itself public domain (translations can carry separate, newer copyrights).
- ☐ If CC-licensed, record the exact license type (BY, BY-SA, BY-NC, etc.) and required attribution wording.
- ☐ Screenshot or archive the source page showing the licensing status, filed in the title's project folder.
- ☐ Re-verify status for your primary distribution country and any major secondary market.

Rule of thumb: If you can't find a clear, explicit statement of public-domain or CC status, don't produce it. There is always another title on Project Gutenberg.

3.3 AI Narration Tool Terms of Service

Legal safety doesn't stop at the book. Each AI voice-generation platform has its own commercial-use terms, some of which restrict monetized content, require attribution, or limit voice-cloning usage. Before publishing your first monetized episode with any new tool, read its current commercial-use and content-ownership terms in full — these change frequently as the tools evolve.

3.4 Music & Sound Effects Licensing

- Only use tracks explicitly licensed for the platform you're publishing to (podcast platforms, YouTube, and social audio clips each have separate content-ID systems).
- Keep a signed or logged record of every music license (subscription tier, download date, track ID) in your resource tracker.
- Avoid "free download" sites without a clear license; a track with no license is not automatically safe.

3.5 Public Domain Timing by Jurisdiction (General Reference)

Public domain rules vary by country and change periodically. Treat the figures below as a starting orientation, not legal certainty — always verify the specific title and current law before production.

Jurisdiction	General Rule of Thumb	Watch-Out
United States	Generally, works published before 1930 are public domain; the cutoff year advances annually	Editions, translations, and annotations published later may carry separate copyright
United Kingdom / EU	Generally, life of the author plus 70 years	An author who died recently may still be in copyright even for an old-sounding title
Canada	Generally, life of the author plus 70 years (as of recent reform)	Rules changed in recent years — reconfirm current status before use
Australia	Generally, life of the author plus 70 years	Cross-check against the specific edition's publication date

Safest practice: When in doubt about a borderline title, choose a different, unambiguously-clear public-domain book instead. The sourcing pool (Chapter 5) is large enough that legal ambiguity is never worth the risk.

Chapter 4

The Audio Production Pipeline

Learn how to identify stories suitable for audiobook production, evaluate audience appeal, select sustainable genres, and build a content catalogue with long-term multimedia potential.

Every audio episode moves through the same five-stage pipeline, regardless of genre or length. This chapter is the master map; every later chapter zooms into one stage of it.

The success of an audiobook begins long before recording starts. Selecting the right story determines audience interest, production complexity, marketing opportunities, and the potential for future adaptations. A carefully chosen story can become the foundation of an entire media franchise.

Choose stories you genuinely enjoy. Your enthusiasm will influence narration quality, production consistency, and long-term motivation. Before investing time in production, ask whether the story has enough emotional impact to keep listeners engaged from beginning to end.

Evaluate each story using five criteria: audience appeal, emotional impact, production complexity, adaptation potential, and long-term multimedia value. Prioritize stories with balanced strengths across all categories. Select three stories you would like to adapt. Score each one using the Story Selection Matrix and explain which story you would choose first and why.

4.1 Master Pipeline — High-Level View

Source	Adapt	Narrate	Sound Design	Publish
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4.2 Master Pipeline — Detailed Stage Guide

1	Source	Identify and legally clear a public-domain or CC-licensed book (Chapters 5–6).
2	Adapt	Rewrite selected passages into ear-ready, scene-beat script (Chapters 7–8).

3	Narrate	Generate AI voice performances, direct for emotion and pacing (Chapters 9–11).
4	Sound Design	Layer ambience, SFX, and licensed music under the narration (Chapter 12).
5	Publish & Iterate	Export, post, track engagement, and feed learnings back into the next title (Chapters 14–16).

4.3 Roles Mapped to the Pipeline

Stage	Primary Role Responsible	Handbook Chapter
Source & Adapt	Story Editor / Adapter	5–8
Narrate & Sound Design	Audio Producer	9–13
Publish & Iterate	Growth / Social Manager	14–16
Cross-cutting	Production Lead (you)	17–20

4.4 Where This Pipeline Connects to Video (Optional Next Step)

If, after publishing audio-only content, you decide to expand into cinematic video, the exact final audio file this pipeline produces becomes the starting input for Volume 2's pipeline. Nothing about how you build your audio needs to change in anticipation of that — Volume 2 is designed to work with any well-produced, cleanly exported audio episode, whether or not it was made using this handbook.

4.5 Chapter Checklist

- ☐ Read the Legal Clearance Checklist (Chapter 3) before selecting your first title.
- ☐ Print or pin the Master Pipeline diagram somewhere visible during production.
- ☐ Identify which pipeline stage you personally will own first.
- ☐ Bookmark the chapter matching each future collaborator's role for fast onboarding.

PART II

Sourcing & Story Development

Finding books, evaluating them, and adapting prose into ear-ready script

Chapter 5

Book Sourcing Playbook

This chapter is the definitive, expanded guide to finding legally clear books, replacing ad-hoc searching with a repeatable sourcing routine.

5.1 Primary Source Directory

Source	Best For	Sourcing Tip
Project Gutenberg	Classic romance, adventure, spiritual/philosophy texts	Use the Bookshelf browsing feature to filter by genre instead of scrolling the full catalog.
Standard Ebooks	Beautifully formatted, typo-checked public domain books	Download the EPUB — chapter breaks are already clean, saving adaptation time.
ManyBooks	Older romance, business/self-help, and general literature	Sort by Popularity to find titles readers already recognize.
LibriVox	Free public-domain audiobooks for pacing reference	Listen to an existing narration first, even if you generate your own AI voice.
Open Library	Massive digitized catalog, strong for niche spiritual/self-help titles	Use it to cross-check a book's original publication date.
Wikisource	Original-language texts, letters, speeches, and shorter public-domain works	Good for producing shorter standalone episodes between full-novel serials.
Internet Archive Texts (verified public-domain only)	Backup search when a title isn't on the above sites	Confirm licensing status directly on the item page before use.

5.2 Building a Sourcing Routine

1. Set a monthly "sourcing session": one hour dedicated purely to browsing and shortlisting titles, separate from production time.
2. Maintain a running shortlist spreadsheet with columns: Title, Author, Source Link, Genre, Word Count, License Status, and Verified Date.
3. Batch-verify licensing status for the whole shortlist at once rather than one title at a time.
4. Tag each shortlisted title with a target format: Full Serial, Standalone Short, or Business/Self-Help Summary.

Efficiency tip: Source three to five titles per session so you always have a backlog — never start a sourcing session under production deadline pressure.

5.3 Genre Sourcing Notes

- Romance: Project Gutenberg and ManyBooks have the deepest catalogs; look for authors like Austen, Alcott, and the Brontës as recognizable anchors.
- Mystery/Adventure: Search for Doyle, Christie's earliest works (check date), and Verne for strong cliffhanger structure.
- Business/Self-Help: Open Library and ManyBooks carry early 20th-century success-and-motivation titles that read surprisingly well as modern summaries.
- Spiritual/Philosophy: Project Gutenberg's philosophy shelf is the strongest single source; pair with Open Library for cross-referencing translations.

5.4 Deeper Genre Playbooks

Romance Playbook

Romance performs best when the adaptation leans into interiority — what a character feels, not just what happens. Prioritize passages with charged dialogue or a clear emotional turn (a confession, a misunderstanding, a reunion).

Mystery/Thriller Playbook

Mystery adaptations succeed on withheld information. Choose passages that end mid-question rather than mid-answer, and preserve any moment where a character notices something the reader doesn't yet understand.

Adventure Playbook

Adventure content rewards momentum. Favor passages with physical action and clear stakes over reflective or descriptive chapters, and look for natural chase, escape, or discovery sequences.

Business/Self-Help Playbook

These titles work best condensed into clear, numbered takeaways rather than dramatized scenes — treat the adaptation more like a well-written summary than a script with characters.

Chapter 6

Selecting & Evaluating Source Material

Not every legally-clear book makes a good adaptation. This chapter gives you a scoring rubric so title selection is a repeatable decision, not a guess.

Learn how to read a novel from a producer's perspective, identify essential story elements, organize production notes, and prepare a manuscript for audiobook adaptation. A producer reads differently from a casual reader. Beyond enjoying the story, the producer identifies scene boundaries, character introductions, emotional peaks, dialogue, narration opportunities, recurring themes, and locations that will influence narration and sound design.

6.1 The EJIMAX-C Title Scoring Rubric

Criterion	1 (Weak)	3 (Workable)	5 (Excellent)
Opening hook strength	Slow scene-setting for pages	Hook appears within first chapter	Hook lands in the first paragraph
Dialogue density	Mostly narration/description	Balanced narration and dialogue	Dialogue-driven, highly performable
Built-in cliffhangers	Few natural act breaks	Some chapter-end tension	Frequent, strong cliffhangers
Audience recognizability	Obscure title/author	Recognizable genre, unknown title	Widely recognized title or author
Length manageability	Over 150,000 words	60,000–150,000 words	Under 90,000 words for a pilot

Score each candidate 1–5 on all five criteria. Anything averaging 3.5 or above is a strong production candidate; below 2.5, archive it for later or skip it.

6.2 Format Decision Tree

1	Score ≥ 4 avg	Full Serial — multi-episode adaptation released weekly, driving a returning audience.
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2	Score 3–4 avg	Standalone Short — single 3–8 minute cinematic piece from the strongest chapter.
3	Non-fiction title	Business/Self-Help Summary — condensed narrated takeaways, avatar-narrator style.
4	Score < 2.5 avg	Archive — revisit only if a stronger adaptation angle emerges later.

6.3 Title Evaluation Template

Copy this template for every candidate title before greenlighting production:

Field	Entry
Title / Author	_____
Source & License	_____
Word Count	_____
Rubric Score (avg)	_____
Chosen Format	_____
Target Episode Count	_____
Standout Passage(s) for Pilot	_____

6.4 Chapter Checklist

- ☐ Score every shortlisted title using the rubric before committing production time.
- ☐ Confirm chosen format (Serial / Short / Summary) matches the rubric outcome.
- ☐ Fill out one Title Evaluation Template per greenlit book, filed in the project folder.

Chapter 7

Adapting Prose Into Script: The Adaptation Method

This chapter is the core craft chapter of Part II — the method for turning 19th-century prose into a script that performs on modern audio and video.

Learn how to transform a novel into a narration-ready audiobook script, organize narration and dialogue, preserve the author's intent, and prepare scripts for recording.

Script adaptation is the bridge between reading and production. Rather than reading a novel exactly as printed, producers organize narration into clear recording segments, mark pauses, emotional cues, pronunciation notes, and scene transitions while preserving the story's meaning. Dialogue should be easy for narrators to perform. Separate narration from spoken lines, identify speakers clearly, add performance notes where appropriate, and maintain consistent formatting throughout the script.

After adapting a script, review it from the narrator's perspective. Simplify awkward sentences, add pause markers, identify emotional shifts, mark pronunciation of uncommon names, and ensure transitions between scenes sound natural. Read the script aloud to identify areas that require improvement before recording.

An organized script reduces recording mistakes, speeds editing, and helps maintain consistent pacing across long productions.

7.1 The Five-Pass Adaptation Method

1	Pass 1: Select	Choose the hook-heaviest passage — conflict, dialogue, or reveal, never pure scene-setting.
2	Pass 2: Shorten	Break long period sentences into two or three short, speakable sentences.
3	Pass 3: Modernize	Replace archaic or obscure vocabulary only where it would confuse a modern listener — preserve voice otherwise.
4	Pass 4: Cue	Label every line of dialogue with the speaking character for multi-voice narration.
5	Pass 5: Pace	Insert punctuation (em dashes, ellipses, line breaks) to mark dramatic pauses for the AI voice engine.

7.2 Before & After Example

Original (public-domain style prose):

It was a truth universally acknowledged, that a single man in possession of a good fortune, must be in want of a wife; however little known the feelings or views of such a man may be on his first entering a neighbourhood, this truth is so well fixed in the minds of the surrounding families.

Adapted for ear-first audio:

NARRATOR: *Everyone agreed on one thing — a wealthy single man needed a wife. It didn't matter what he actually wanted. The families around him had already decided.*

7.3 Scene-Beat Breakdown

Once a passage is adapted, break it into scene beats — the unit both your audio director and, later, your video storyboard will work from.

Beat #	Script Excerpt	Emotional Tone	Est. Duration
1	NARRATOR opening line...	Wry, observational	8 sec
2	Dialogue exchange begins...	Tense, flirtatious	15 sec
3	Reveal / cliffhanger line...	Sharp, urgent	6 sec

7.4 Common Adaptation Pitfalls

- Over-modernizing: stripping so much period vocabulary that the book's identity disappears.
- Under-cutting: leaving 40-word sentences intact, producing flat, monotone AI narration.
- Losing the hook: adapting the technically "correct" opening chapter instead of the most engaging passage.
- Missing speaker cues: forcing a single-voice narration where multi-voice would perform far better.

Craft tip: Read your adapted script aloud before generating any AI voice. If you stumble, the AI will sound unnatural at that exact spot.

Chapter 8

Script Templates & Scene-Beat Worksheets

Ready-to-copy templates for every adaptation session, so script development never starts from a blank page.

8.1 Master Script Template

Field	Entry
Title / Chapter	_____
Target Runtime	_____
Characters & Assigned Voices	_____
Adapted Script Text	(full text, cued by speaker)
Pacing Notes	_____

8.2 Scene-Beat Worksheet (feeds directly into Chapter 14 Storyboarding)

Beat #	Audio Timestamp	Script Line(s)	Tone/Mood

8.3 Adaptation Session Checklist

- ☐ Selected passage scores high on hook strength (Chapter 6 rubric).
- ☐ Completed all five adaptation passes (Select, Shorten, Modernize, Cue, Pace).
- ☐ Read the full script aloud at least once before moving to narration.
- ☐ Scene-Beat Worksheet completed and filed for the storyboarding stage.
- ☐ Script saved in the shared project folder with version number in the filename.

PART III

Audio Production

Voice design, AI narration tools, sound design, and quality control

Chapter 9

Voice & Character Design Guide

Before generating a single line of narration, define the voice identity of the piece. This chapter turns "pick a voice" into a deliberate design decision. Document the main characters, supporting characters, conflicts, themes, settings, timeline, emotional turning points, and important dialogue. These notes become the blueprint for script adaptation and audio production.

Understand the fundamentals of directing narration, managing pacing, shaping emotional delivery, and preparing either AI or human narrators for consistent audiobook performances. Voice direction begins long before recording. Review the script, identify emotional shifts, define the narrator's role, establish pronunciation standards, and decide how different characters should sound. The goal is clarity, consistency, and emotional authenticity rather than exaggerated acting.

Understand how voice sound design enhances storytelling, learn to plan ambience, sound effects, and music, and build immersive audio environments for professional audiobooks. Voice sound is one of the strongest emotional tools available to a producer. Carefully chosen voice effects help listeners connect emotionally with characters without overwhelming the narration.

Practice reading the same paragraph in different emotional styles—curiosity, excitement, sadness, and suspense. Record yourself and compare which version best supports the story.

9.1 Voice Design Dimensions

Dimension	Options to Consider
Register	Warm/intimate, neutral/broadcast, dramatic/theatrical
Pace	Slow and deliberate, brisk and energetic, variable by scene
Accent/Origin	Match the book's setting, or choose a neutral accessible accent
Age quality	Younger, mature, elderly — should match narrator or POV character
Emotional range	How wide a swing the voice needs from calm to intense scenes

9.2 Building a Character Voice Sheet

For every recurring character, complete one row before recording begins. This becomes your reference so a character's voice never drifts across episodes.

Character	Platform + Voice ID	Register/Accent	Notes
Narrator			
Lead A			
Lead B			

Consistency tip: Save the exact voice ID/settings string from your chosen tool, not just the voice name — providers periodically update default voices, which can subtly change the sound.

9.3 Matching Voice to Genre

- Romance: warmer, more intimate register; slower pace during emotional beats, quicker during banter.
- Mystery/Thriller: neutral-to-tense register; deliberate pacing with pointed pauses before reveals.
- Business/Self-Help: confident, brisk, conversational — closer to a podcast host than a stage actor.
- Adventure: energetic pace with more dynamic range for action sequences.

Chapter 10

AI Narration Tool Directory & Comparison

A comparison of the primary AI voice generation platforms used across EJIMAX-C productions, with guidance on when to reach for each one.

This section provides a structured overview of available AI-powered narration tools, helping readers understand what each tool does, how they differ, and which one might be best suited for specific needs. It combines a **directory** (a list of tools with descriptions) and a **comparison** (side-by-side evaluation of features).

By combining a directory and comparison:

- You can discover available tools quickly.
- You can evaluate features side by side without needing to test each tool themselves.
- It helps you choose the right tool for their project — whether that's professional narration, accessibility, or creative storytelling.

10.1 Tool Comparison Table

Platform	Best Used For	Key Feature	Starting Guidance
ElevenLabs	Cinematic romance & dialogue	Unmatched emotional depth and voice cloning	Start on the entry paid tier; lower the stability setting for more emotional variation.
PlayHT	Business & non-fiction summaries	Clean, ultra-realistic conversational narration	Strong second tool once you expand into non-fiction titles.
Murf.ai	Multi-character voice acting	Easy switching between narrator and character voices	Use the voice library to assign one distinct voice per character up front.
OpenAI TTS	Fast, high-quality audio summaries	Cost-effective and natural delivery	Good for testing a script's pacing

Platform	Best Used For	Key Feature	Starting Guidance
			before spending premium credits.

10.2 Choosing a Tool by Production Stage

1	Draft testing	Use a low-cost/free tier tool to confirm pacing and script quality before investing credits.
2	Pilot production	Move to your primary emotional-performance tool (typically ElevenLabs) for the final take.
3	Multi-character scenes	Use a tool built for character switching (Murf.ai) if the scene has 3+ distinct speakers.
4	Non-fiction/summary content	Use a conversational-register tool (PlayHT or OpenAI TTS) for business/self-help titles.

10.3 Budget Planning

Every platform above offers a free or trial tier. A sustainable monthly budget for a solo creator typically starts with one paid narration subscription (for the primary performance tool) and free/trial usage of the others for testing — scale up only once a title's engagement data justifies the spend.

Chapter 11

Recording, Directing & QA of AI Narration

This section outlines the professional process of creating high-quality AI narration. Even though AI voices are generated digitally, the workflow mirrors traditional audio production: **recording**, **directing**, and **quality assurance (QA)**.



Recording

Generating a voice line is not the same as directing a performance. This chapter treats AI narration generation as a directing discipline.

- **Definition:** In AI narration, “recording” refers to generating the voice output from text input. Unlike human recording, this is done through text-to-speech engines.
- **Key steps:**
 - Inputting the script into the AI tool.
 - Selecting the voice style (male/female, accent, tone).
 - Adjusting pacing, pauses, and emphasis for clarity.
- **Best practices:**
 - Break long scripts into sections for smoother delivery.
 - Use punctuation and formatting to guide rhythm.
 - Preview small samples before committing to full narration.



Directing

- **Definition:** Directing is the creative control over how the narration *sounds* — shaping tone, emotion, and delivery.
- **Key steps:**
 - Choosing the right voice for the audience (e.g., warm and friendly for e-learning, authoritative for corporate training).
 - Adjusting emotional cues (serious, cheerful, and empathetic).
 - Ensuring consistency across chapters, modules, or episodes.

- **Best practices:**
 - Match narration style to brand identity.
 - Use voice cloning sparingly and only when ethical/consented.
 - Provide clear direction notes in the script (e.g., “pause here,” “emphasize this word”).

✓ Quality Assurance (QA)

- **Definition:** QA ensures the narration meets professional standards before release.
- **Key checks:**
 - **Clarity** — Is the audio free of glitches, distortions, or robotic artifacts?
 - **Accuracy** — Does the narration match the script exactly (no skipped or mispronounced words)?
 - **Consistency** — Is the tone uniform across the project?
 - **Accessibility** — Does pacing suit the target audience (e.g., slower for learners, faster for entertainment)?
- **Best practices:**
 - Run multiple playback tests on different devices (headphones, speakers).
 - Have a human reviewer listen for naturalness.
 - Correct mispronunciations by adjusting phonetic spelling in the script.

11.1 The Direction Loop

Generate	Listen	Diagnose	Adjust	Regenerate	Approve
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11.2 Diagnosing a Weak Take

Symptom	Likely Cause	Fix
Flat, monotone delivery	Sentence too long / no punctuation cues	Break sentence, add pauses (em dash, ellipsis)

Symptom	Likely Cause	Fix
Wrong emotional tone	Stability/emotion setting mismatched to scene	Adjust stability or style-exaggeration setting, regenerate
Mispronounced word	Unusual or archaic word confusing the model	Respell phonetically or replace with modern synonym
Pacing too fast/rushed	No natural breath points in the script	Insert line breaks or short pause markers
Character voice drifted	Wrong voice ID selected, or model updated default	Re-check the Character Voice Sheet (Chapter 9) and reselect exact ID

11.3 Narration QA Checklist

- ☐ Listen to the full take on headphones, not laptop speakers.
- ☐ Check pacing against the Scene-Beat Worksheet's estimated durations.
- ☐ Confirm every character matches their Voice Sheet entry.
- ☐ Flag and regenerate any line that sounds robotic or mispronounced.
- ☐ Export final approved audio as WAV or high-bitrate MP3 into the project folder.

Chapter 12

Sound Design: Ambience, SFX, Music Licensing

Sound design is what separates a flat text-to-speech clip from an immersive audio drama with audio layers that make the listening experience more engaging and professional. This chapter covers layering technique and licensing discipline.

- **Ambience** — Background sounds that set the mood or environment (e.g., rain, city noise, nature). They create atmosphere and help listeners imagine the setting.
- **SFX** (Sound Effects) — Short, distinct sounds that highlight actions or transitions (e.g., footsteps, applause, door creaks). They add realism and emphasize key moments.
- **Music Licensing** — The legal use of music tracks in narration projects. Options include royalty-free libraries, Creative Commons tracks, or custom compositions. Proper licensing ensures compliance and avoids copyright issues.

12.1 The Three Sound Layers

Layer	Purpose	Volume Guidance
Narration/Dialogue	The story itself — always the dominant layer	0 dB reference (full volume)
Ambience/SFX	Sets scene and mood (rain, footsteps, room tone)	-15 to -20 dB relative to narration
Music	Emotional undercurrent, transitions, tension building	-18 to -24 dB, ducked further during dialogue

12.2 Genre-Based Sound Palettes

- Cozy Romance: rain on windows, crackling fireplace, soft piano or strings.
- Mystery/Thriller: low drone strings, distant footsteps, clock ticking for tension.
- Adventure: wind, movement/travel sounds, rising orchestral swells at cliffhangers.
- Business/Self-Help: minimal, clean — light ambient pad only, no distracting SFX.

12.3 Licensing Discipline

5. Only source music/SFX from platforms with clear commercial and platform-specific licenses (e.g., Epidemic Sound, Artlist).
6. Log every track used: title, source platform, license tier, download date.
7. Before publishing to a new platform (e.g., first-time Spotify release), re-confirm that platform is covered by your license tier.
8. Avoid unlicensed "free download" sources — a missing license can result in a content strike or takedown after the fact.

12.4 Chapter Checklist

- ☐ Narration is the loudest, clearest layer in every scene.
- ☐ Ambience and music levels ducked appropriately under dialogue.
- ☐ Genre-appropriate sound palette selected and consistent across the title's episodes.
- ☐ All music/SFX logged with source, license tier, and date.

Chapter 13

Audio Production Checklist & Templates

The complete, copy-ready audio production tracker for a single episode.

13.1 Episode Audio Production Tracker

Field	Entry
Title / Episode #	_____
Script Version	_____
Voice Tool + Voice IDs Used	_____
Narration Status	Draft / Directed / Approved
Sound Design Status	Not Started / In Progress / Complete
Music Track(s) + License	_____
Final Export Filename	_____
QA Sign-off	_____

13.2 End-of-Part Master Checklist

- ☐ Character Voice Sheet completed for all recurring characters.
- ☐ Primary narration tool selected and tested against the budget plan.
- ☐ Full narration take directed, QA'd, and approved.
- ☐ Sound design layered and levels checked against the Three Sound Layers guidance.
- ☐ Episode Audio Production Tracker filed before moving to Part IV — Visual Production.

PART IV

Publishing Your Audio

Export specs, growth tactics, content calendar, and analytics for audio-only content

Chapter 14

Audio Publishing Specs & Growth Playbook

Producing a great episode is only half the job. This chapter covers exactly how to package it for each platform and the specific tactics that earn discovery for audio-first content.

14.1 Export Specification Table

Platform	Format	Ideal Length	Notes
Podcast platforms (Spotify, Apple Podcasts)	MP3/WAV, ID3-tagged	Full chapter/episode length	Include episode art, description, and any required attribution text
YouTube (audio-only upload)	MP4 with static or simple animated cover art	Full episode length	Add captions/subtitles for accessibility and discoverability
TikTok / Reels / Shorts (audio teaser)	Vertical static-image video with waveform or captions	15–60 sec	Use the most dramatic 15–30 seconds of narration as a teaser
Instagram feed	Static aesthetic quote graphic + short audio clip	Under 90 sec	Pair narration snippet with a mood-appropriate quote card

14.2 Target Audience Segments

Segment	What They Want
BookTok / audiobook community	Aesthetic, mood-driven content; recognizable classic titles
Busy professionals	Fast, high-quality summaries they can consume during downtime

Segment	What They Want
Student multitaskers	Bite-sized story hits between study sessions
Existing podcast/audiobook listeners	Consistent release schedule and reliable audio quality

14.3 Core Growth Tactics for Audio Content

- Hook the BookTok/audiobook community: pair episodes with recognizable, well-loved titles and evocative episode art.
- Gamify the audio: end episodes with a direct question ("What should the protagonist do next? Comment A or B") to drive comments.
- Use "Part 1" traps: release the juiciest cliffhanger chapter first and require a follow for Part 2.
- Solve a stated problem: market summaries directly to "I wish I had time to read, but I'm too busy" audiences.
- Series anchoring: give each title a consistent episode-art template and audio intro/outro so returning listeners recognize it instantly.
- Cross-promotion: reference earlier episodes in new descriptions to drive back-catalog listens.

14.4 Chapter Checklist

- ☐ Correct export format confirmed for every target platform.
- ☐ At least one engagement question or cliffhanger included per episode.
- ☐ Consistent episode art and audio bumper applied across the title.

Chapter 15

Content Calendar Template

A ready-to-copy weekly and monthly calendar structure so publishing never becomes reactive.

15.1 Weekly Calendar Template

Day	Platform	Content	Status
Monday	Podcast release		
Tuesday	TikTok/Reels/Shorts (teaser)		
Wednesday	Instagram feed		
Thursday	TikTok/Reels/Shorts (teaser)		
Friday	YouTube (audio-only)		
Saturday	Community engagement / replies		
Sunday	Rest / planning		

15.1b Filled Example — Week 3 of a Pride and Prejudice Serial

Day	Platform	Content	Status
Monday	Podcast release	Episode 3 full audio drama release	Scheduled
Tuesday	TikTok/Reels/Shorts	30-second cliffhanger teaser from Episode 3's closing line	Scheduled
Wednesday	Instagram feed	Quote card: "A truth universally acknowledged..." with ambient narration clip	Scheduled
Thursday	TikTok/Reels/Shorts	12-second first-look teaser for Episode 4	Draft in review

Day	Platform	Content	Status
Friday	YouTube (audio-only)	Episodes 1–3 compiled into a single long-form audio upload	In editing
Saturday	Community engagement	Reply to comments on Episode 2's engagement question	Ongoing
Sunday	Rest / planning	Review Week 3 analytics; source next title's shortlist	Not started

15.2 Monthly Planning Template

Field	Entry
Titles in production this month	_____
Titles in publishing queue	_____
Top-performing episode from last month	_____
Adjustments for this month	_____

Chapter 16

Analytics & Iteration Framework

Growth compounds only if you learn from every episode. This chapter is the framework for turning platform analytics into concrete production decisions.

16.1 Core Metrics to Track Per Platform

Platform	Primary Metric	Secondary Metric
Podcast platforms	Episode completion rate	Follower/subscriber growth
YouTube (audio-only)	Average view duration	Click-through rate on thumbnail
TikTok/Reels/Shorts teasers	Completion rate	Comment rate / click-through to full episode
Instagram	Saves/shares	Profile visits

16.2 The Iteration Loop

Publish	Measure	Diagnose	Adjust Next Episode	Publish Again
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16.3 Diagnostic Questions After Each Episode

- Did the opening hook (first 5–10 seconds) hold attention, or did drop-off happen immediately?
- Did the cliffhanger/engagement question generate comments?
- Which narration style or pacing choice produced the highest completion rate?
- Did the voice/tone match the genre, based on listener comment sentiment?

16.4 Chapter Checklist

- ☐ Core metrics reviewed weekly for every published episode.
- ☐ At least one concrete adjustment identified and applied to the next episode.
- ☐ High-performing narration or engagement tactics logged back into your production notes.

PART V

Team & Operations

Roles, onboarding, quality control, and troubleshooting for audio production

Chapter 17

Team Roles & Responsibilities (SOPs)

As an audio production channel grows beyond a solo operation, this chapter defines each role's standard operating responsibilities so work can be delegated without losing consistency.

A successful AI narration project requires clear **roles**, defined **responsibilities**, and documented **SOPs (Standard Operating Procedures)**. This ensures efficiency, accountability, and consistent quality across projects.

17.1 Role Definitions

Role	Owns	Key Handbook Chapters
Production Lead	Overall pipeline, greenlighting titles, quality standards	1, 4, 19
Story Editor / Adapter	Sourcing, evaluation, script adaptation	5–8
Audio Producer	Voice design, narration direction, sound design	9–13
Growth / Social Manager	Publishing, calendar, analytics, engagement	14–16

17.2 Handoff Points Between Roles

1	Story Editor → Audio Producer	Locked, cued script with Scene-Beat Worksheet.
2	Audio Producer → Growth Manager	Final approved audio file plus the Episode Audio Production Tracker.

17.3 Chapter Checklist

- ☐ Every role has a named owner (even if one person holds multiple roles today).
- ☐ Handoff templates from prior chapters used at every transition point.

Chapter 18

Onboarding New Collaborators

Onboarding is the structured process of welcoming and preparing new collaborators to join your project team. It ensures they understand the **tools, workflows, SOPs, and expectations** before they begin contributing. A first-day guide for anyone joining an audio production role.

18.1 Day-One Checklist

- ☐ Read Chapters 1–4 (Foundations) in full, regardless of assigned role.
- ☐ Read the chapters matching your specific role, per the Chapter 17 role table.
- ☐ Review the current title's project folder: source clearance record, script, and audio production tracker.
- ☐ Confirm access to the relevant AI narration tools for your role.
- ☐ Listen to one completed episode end-to-end before starting new work.

18.2 First Assignment Guidance

- New Story Editors: complete one full Title Evaluation Template (Chapter 6) on a candidate book before adapting anything.
- New Audio Producers: complete one Character Voice Sheet (Chapter 9) and direct one short test scene before a live episode.
- New Growth Managers: publish one back-catalog episode across all platforms using the export spec table (Chapter 14.1) as a practice run.

18.3 Brand Standards Briefing

Every new collaborator should review Chapter 19 (Quality Control & Brand Standards) before their first deliverable is published under the channel's name.

Chapter 19

Quality Control & Brand Standards

This chapter defines what "quality" means concretely for an audio-first production, so standards don't drift as the team grows. This section ensures that every AI narration project meets professional standards and aligns with the organization's brand identity. It combines **technical quality checks** with **brand consistency guidelines**.

19.1 Brand Identity Elements

Element	Standard
Intro/outro audio bumper	Consistent across all episodes; include in every final export
Episode art template	Consistent visual template applied per title
Voice consistency	Locked per Character Voice Sheet; no unapproved substitutions
Legal disclosure	Public-domain/CC source credited where required by license

19.2 Pre-Publish Quality Gate

No episode publishes without clearing this final gate, regardless of who produced it.

- ☐ Source legally cleared and documented (Chapter 3).
- ☐ Script adaptation reviewed against the Five-Pass Method (Chapter 7).
- ☐ Narration QA'd and approved (Chapter 11).
- ☐ Sound design layered and leveled per the Three Sound Layers guidance (Chapter 12).
- ☐ Audio bumper applied and correct export format confirmed for each target platform (Chapter 14.1).

19.3 Standards Update Process

When a better technique, tool, or format is discovered, document it here with the date and rationale before adopting it team-wide, so this handbook stays the single source of truth.

Chapter 20

Troubleshooting Guide

A troubleshooting guide and a structured reference that outlines **common problems**, their **likely causes**, and **recommended solutions**. It ensures that technical or creative issues are resolved efficiently without disrupting project timelines.

A fast-reference table for the most common audio production problems and their fixes, organized by pipeline stage.

20.1 Sourcing & Script Issues

Problem	Fix
Can't confirm a book's public domain status	Cross-check publication date and country on two independent sources (Chapter 3); if still unclear, skip the title
Adapted script sounds flat when read aloud	Re-run the Shorten and Pace passes (Chapter 7); read aloud again before narrating
Chosen passage doesn't have a strong enough hook	Return to Chapter 6's rubric and re-score alternate passages before committing

20.2 Audio Issues

Problem	Fix
Narration sounds robotic	Adjust stability/emotion settings and add punctuation-based pacing cues (Chapter 11)
Music overwhelms dialogue	Re-check Three Sound Layers volume guidance (Chapter 12) and duck music further
Voice tool mispronounces a name repeatedly	Add a phonetic respelling to the Character Voice Sheet so it's consistent every time
Budget running over on narration credits	Draft and test scripts on a free-tier tool first; reserve the primary paid tool for final takes only (Chapter 10.3)

20.3 Distribution Issues

Problem	Fix
Low completion rate on episodes	Strengthen the opening hook; review Chapter 14.3 growth tactics
Engagement question isn't generating comments	Make the choice more concrete (A or B) rather than open-ended
Content performs well on one platform but not another	Re-check the export spec table (Chapter 14.1) — a mismatched format or length often explains the gap

20.4 Escalation Path

If a problem isn't resolved by this chapter, document it (symptom, what was tried, outcome) and add it here after resolution — this keeps the troubleshooting guide current for the next person who hits the same issue.

PART VI

Appendices

Resources, full template library, worked case studies, and quick-start plan

Appendix A

Free Book Sources & AI Narration Tools

A.1 Free & Legal Book Sources

Project Gutenberg: <https://www.gutenberg.org> — Classic romance, adventure, spiritual texts

Standard Ebooks: <https://standardebooks.org> — Beautifully formatted public domain books

ManyBooks: <https://manybooks.net> — Older romance, business, and literature

LibriVox: <https://librivox.org> — Free public-domain audiobooks for style reference

Open Library: <https://openlibrary.org> — Millions of digitized books to cross-check publication dates

Wikisource: <https://wikisource.org> — Original-language texts, letters, and speeches

Internet Archive: <https://archive.org> — Backup search — verify licensing on the item page

A.2 AI Audio / Narration Tools

ElevenLabs: <https://elevenlabs.io> — Cinematic romance & dialogue, voice cloning

PlayHT: <https://play.ht> — Business & non-fiction narration

Murf.ai: <https://murf.ai> — Multi-character voice acting

OpenAI TTS: <https://platform.openai.com> — Fast, cost-effective narration

A.3 Editing, Music & SFX Tools

Adobe Audition / Premiere Pro: <https://www.adobe.com/products/audition.html> — Professional-grade audio editing

Descript: <https://www.descript.com> — Text-based audio editing, easy for beginners

Epidemic Sound: <https://www.epidemicsound.com> — Royalty-free music and SFX

Artlist: <https://artlist.io> — Royalty-free music and SFX

Maintenance note: AI tool capabilities change quickly. Re-review this appendix every quarter and update entries as tools improve or new ones emerge.

Appendix B

Full Template Library (Quick-Reference Index)

Every fillable template introduced across this handbook, indexed here for fast retrieval.

Template	Chapter	Purpose
Title Evaluation Template	6	Score and greenlight candidate books
Master Script Template	8	Structure a full adapted episode script
Scene-Beat Worksheet	8	Break script into timed, describable beats
Character Voice Sheet	9	Lock voice IDs per character
Episode Audio Production Tracker	13	Track narration and sound design status
Weekly Content Calendar	15	Plan platform-by-platform posting schedule
Monthly Planning Template	15	Review production pipeline and top performers
Pre-Publish Quality Gate	19	Final checklist before any episode goes live

Usage tip: Copy each template into your team's shared spreadsheet or project management tool as a reusable form — this handbook is the reference source, not the working copy.

Appendix C

Glossary of Terms

Term	Definition
Public Domain	A work whose copyright has expired or was never claimed, free for anyone to use
Creative Commons (CC)	A licensing system letting authors pre-approve specific types of reuse
Scene Beat	A short segment of narration paired with one describable moment
Ducking	Lowering the volume of music/ambience beneath dialogue
Cliffhanger Trap	Ending an episode on unresolved tension to drive a follow-up listen
Completion Rate	The percentage of listeners who reach the end of an episode
Voice ID	The exact identifier for a specific AI-generated voice within a narration tool
Stability Setting	A narration-tool parameter controlling how consistent vs. emotionally expressive a voice reads

Appendix D

Quick-Start 7-Day Audio Launch Plan

For a brand-new solo creator: a compressed path from zero to a first published audio episode.

Day	Focus	Handbook Reference
Day 1	Read Part I; run a sourcing session and shortlist 3–5 titles	Chapters 1–5
Day 2	Score shortlist with the rubric; select and legally clear one title	Chapters 3, 6
Day 3	Adapt the pilot passage using the Five-Pass Method	Chapters 7–8
Day 4	Design voices, generate and direct narration	Chapters 9–11
Day 5	Add sound design: ambience, SFX, and licensed music	Chapter 12
Day 6	Export final audio; prepare episode art and platform packaging	Chapters 13–14
Day 7	Run the Pre-Publish Quality Gate and publish across all platforms	Chapters 14, 19

D.1 After Launch

- Log results against the Analytics & Iteration Framework (Chapter 16) within 48 hours of publishing.
- Feed any strong narration or engagement tactics back into your production notes.
- Begin the next sourcing session immediately so the production backlog never runs dry.

Appendix E

Worked Case Study — Pride and Prejudice

A full walkthrough of every template in this book, completed for a real pilot title, from evaluation through final published audio.

E.1 Title Evaluation Template (Completed)

Field	Entry
Title / Author	Pride and Prejudice / Jane Austen
Source & License	Project Gutenberg — verified public domain (published 1813)
Word Count	~122,000
Rubric Score (avg)	4.4 — strong dialogue density, recognizable title, frequent chapter-end tension
Chosen Format	Full Serial — weekly episodes by chapter cluster
Target Episode Count	12, opening with the ballroom introduction chapters
Standout Passage(s) for Pilot	Opening chapter's narrator commentary plus the first Bennet family dialogue scene

E.2 Adapted Script (Five-Pass Method Applied)

Original passage (public domain text):

It was a truth universally acknowledged, that a single man in possession of a good fortune, must be in want of a wife; however little known the feelings or views of such a man may be on his first entering a neighbourhood, this truth is so well fixed in the minds of the surrounding families.

After adaptation:

NARRATOR: Everyone agreed on one thing — a wealthy single man needed a wife. It didn't matter what he actually wanted. The families around him had already decided.

E.3 Full Episode Script

Beat	Speaker	Line
1	NARRATOR	Everyone agreed on one thing — a wealthy single man needed a wife. It didn't matter what he actually wanted. The families around him had already decided.
2	MRS. BENNET	My dear Mr. Bennet, have you heard? Netherfield Park is let at last!
3	MR. BENNET	I have not. But I'm sure you're about to tell me.
4	MRS. BENNET	A young man of large fortune — four or five thousand a year. What a fine thing for our girls!
5	MR. BENNET	How so? How can it affect them?
6	MRS. BENNET	You must know I am thinking of his marrying one of them.
7	NARRATOR	And so it began — a single piece of news, and an entire household rearranged around it.

E.4 Character Voice Sheet (Completed)

Character	Platform + Voice ID	Register/Accent	Notes
Narrator	ElevenLabs — "Narrator-Wry-01"	Neutral British, dry wit	Slightly lower stability for comic timing
Mrs. Bennet	Murf.ai — "Comic-Insistent-04"	Animated, higher pitch	Faster pace, rising intonation
Mr. Bennet	Murf.ai — "Dry-Deadpan-02"	Calm, measured	Deliberate pauses before punchlines

E.5 Episode Audio Production Tracker (Completed)

Field	Entry
Title / Episode #	Pride and Prejudice — Episode 1
Script Version	v2 (final)

Field	Entry
Voice Tool + Voice IDs Used	ElevenLabs Narrator-Wry-01; Murf.ai Comic-Insistent-04, Dry-Deadpan-02
Narration Status	Approved
Sound Design Status	Complete — light string bed, room tone
Music Track(s) + License	Epidemic Sound, "Quiet Morning Strings" — subscription license
Final Export Filename	PP_Ep01_v2_FINAL.wav
QA Sign-off	Passed Pre-Publish Quality Gate, Chapter 19.2

Appendix F

Second Worked Case Study — Sherlock Holmes

A second full walkthrough in a different genre, showing how voice and pacing shift for mystery content.

F.1 Title Evaluation Template (Completed)

Field	Entry
Title / Author	The Adventures of Sherlock Holmes / Arthur Conan Doyle
Source & License	Project Gutenberg — verified public domain
Word Count	~8,500 per story (anthology of short stories)
Rubric Score (avg)	4.6 — dialogue-driven, iconic recognizability, strong built-in reveals
Chosen Format	Standalone Short — one complete short story per episode
Target Episode Count	6, one per story in the first anthology

F.2 Adapted Script Excerpt

NARRATOR: I had seen little of Holmes lately. But one morning, he strode into the room with the look of a man who already knew the answer to a question no one had asked yet.

HOLMES: You have been in Afghanistan, I perceive.

WATSON: How on earth did you know that?

F.3 Character Voice Sheet (Completed)

Character	Platform + Voice ID	Register/Accent	Notes
Narrator	ElevenLabs — "Narrator-Wry-01"	Neutral British, dry wit	Same narrator voice as the P&P title for cross-title brand consistency

Character	Platform + Voice ID	Register/Accent	Notes
Holmes	ElevenLabs — "Sharp-Deductive-01"	Precise, controlled	Minimal pacing pauses — confidence reads as speed
Watson	Murf.ai — "Warm-Startled-03"	Warmer, reactive	Slight upward inflection on questions

F.4 Cross-Genre Comparison Notes

Element	Romance Example (Appendix E)	Mystery Example (this appendix)
Narration pace	Warmer, slightly slower on emotional beats	Brisk, precise, minimal pauses
Sound palette	Soft strings, room warmth	Low drone, distant clock ticking
Engagement hook style	"What should she do — A or B?"	"What did Holmes notice that you missed?"

Appendix G

Collaborator Role Agreement Templates

As your channel brings on collaborators, use these templates to set clear expectations from day one. These are starting points, not legal contracts — have any paid or ongoing arrangement reviewed by a qualified professional before use.

G.1 Role Agreement Template

Field	Entry
Collaborator Name	_____
Role (per Chapter 17 definitions)	_____
Scope of Work	_____
Deliverables & Format	_____
Handoff Point(s) Owned	_____
Compensation / Arrangement	_____
Brand Standards Acknowledged	Yes / No (Chapter 19 briefing completed)
Start Date	_____

G.2 Freelancer vs. Ongoing Collaborator Checklist

- ☐ Scope of work is specific enough to estimate a deliverable timeline.
- ☐ Compensation terms are documented in writing before work begins.
- ☐ Role Agreement filed alongside the onboarding record from Chapter 18.

Appendix H

Budget & Tool Cost Planner

A framework for planning monthly tool spend as production scales, so costs stay proportional to output and revenue.

H.1 Monthly Tool Budget Worksheet

Tool Category	Tool Selected	Tier	Est. Monthly Cost
Primary narration tool			
Secondary narration tool			
Editing software			
Music/SFX licensing			
Total			

H.2 Scaling Guidance by Stage

1	Stage 1: Testing	Free/trial tiers only across all tool categories while validating the format.
2	Stage 2: Pilot	One paid narration subscription; everything else stays free-tier.
3	Stage 3: Scaling	Add licensing coverage for music/SFX as posting cadence increases.
4	Stage 4: Team	Budget expands to cover collaborator compensation per Appendix G alongside tool costs.

H.3 Cost-Per-Episode Tracking

Field	Entry
Episode Title/#	_____
Narration Credits Used	_____

Field	Entry
Music/SFX Cost	_____
Total Estimated Cost	_____
Listens/Engagement Achieved	_____

Appendix I

ElevenLabs Click-by-Click Walkthrough

A step-by-step navigation guide for generating your first narration take. Interfaces update frequently — treat the structure here as a map of what to look for even if exact button names shift.

I.1 Generating Your First Narration Take

1. Sign in and open the Text to Speech (or "Speech Synthesis") workspace from the main dashboard.
2. Paste your adapted script excerpt into the text input box — one character's lines at a time if using single-voice generation.
3. Open the Voice Library and select or search for a voice matching your Character Voice Sheet entry; note the exact voice name/ID once chosen.
4. Open the generation settings panel and adjust Stability (lower for more emotional variation, higher for more consistency) and Style Exaggeration to match the scene's tone.
5. Click Generate and listen to the result through headphones.
6. If a line sounds off, try regenerating first (AI voice tools vary slightly between takes); if the issue persists, revise the script's punctuation and regenerate.
7. Once approved, download the audio file (WAV recommended) and name it per your project file-naming convention.
8. Repeat per character, then combine all lines in your audio editor in script order before moving to sound design (Chapter 12).

I.2 Troubleshooting

Symptom	First Thing to Try
Generation fails or errors out	Shorten the input text and retry — very long inputs sometimes fail silently
Result sounds nothing like the intended tone	Simplify the direction, then adjust stability/style settings one at a time
Can't find a previously generated file	Check the tool's project/history panel — most platforms keep a searchable generation history

Symptom	First Thing to Try
Running low on credits mid-session	Check the tool's usage dashboard before generating further; switch to a free-tier tool for further testing if needed

Living document note: As you adopt other narration tools from the Chapter 10 directory, add their walkthroughs here using the same numbered-step format.

Appendix J

Style & Voice Guide

Concrete do/don't guidance for keeping every piece of writing — scripts, captions, episode descriptions — recognizably on-brand.

J.1 Brand Voice Principles

Principle	In Practice
Warm, never stuffy	Write like a smart friend telling a story, not an academic lecturing about literature
Confident, not clickbait-desperate	Hooks create genuine curiosity; they don't overpromise and underdeliver
Respect the source	Modernize for the ear without erasing what made the original book distinct
Consistent across formats	A caption, a script line, and an episode description should all sound like the same voice

J.2 Do / Don't Examples

Situation	Don't	Do
Writing a hook description	"You won't BELIEVE what happens next!!!"	"She said yes to the wrong man. Here's how it started."
Adapting narration	Leaving 40-word 19th-century sentences untouched	Breaking into short, speakable sentences while keeping the wit
Naming an episode	"Episode 47"	"Episode 3: The Letter She Wasn't Meant to Read"

J.3 Chapter Checklist

- ☐ New scripts checked against the Do/Don't table before narration begins.
- ☐ Episode descriptions checked against the Brand Voice Principles before publishing.

Appendix K

Frequently Asked Questions

K.1 Legal & Sourcing

Q: Can I use a modern translation of an old public-domain book?

A: Only if that specific translation is itself public domain or CC-licensed — translations often carry their own, newer copyright even when the original text doesn't. Check the translator and publication date separately (Chapter 3).

Q: What if I'm not sure whether a book qualifies?

A: Skip it. The sourcing pool (Chapter 5) is large enough that legal ambiguity is never worth the risk to the channel.

K.2 Audio Production

Q: Do I need professional recording equipment?

A: No — this entire workflow is built around AI-generated narration, so a computer and internet connection are sufficient (Chapter 1).

Q: How do I stop the AI voice from sounding robotic?

A: It's almost always a script pacing issue, not a tool limitation — revisit the Shorten and Pace passes in Chapter 7 before troubleshooting tool settings.

K.3 Growth & Publishing

Q: How often should I post to grow quickly?

A: Consistency matters more than volume, and quality dips quickly when cadence outpaces production capacity (Chapter 14).

Q: My cliffhanger episodes aren't getting comments — what's wrong?

A: Usually the question offered is too vague. Make it concrete and binary ("Comment A or B") rather than open-ended.

K.4 Team & Scaling

Q: When should I bring on my first collaborator?

A: Once one pipeline stage is consistently your bottleneck — use the Role Definitions table (Chapter 17.1) to identify which role to hire first.

Q: Do I need Volume 2 to succeed with an audio-only channel?

A: No. This volume is fully self-contained for an audio-only podcast or audio-drama channel. Volume 2 is only needed if you decide to expand into cinematic video content.

This handbook grows with every title you produce. Update it, correct it, and hand it forward — it is the memory of everything this channel learns.

This concludes Volume 1: Text-to-Audio Novel Generation Handbook. When you're ready to turn a finished audio episode into AI-generated cinematic video, continue with Volume 2: Audio to Image and Movie Cinema Generation Handbook.